

AT A GLANCE



- **LENGTH** 33 ft (10 m)
- **DIET** Carnivore
- **LIVED** 80–73 MYA
- **HABITAT** Rivers and swamps

Deinosuchus's skull was 4 ft (1.3 m) long.

Huge, sharp teeth were adapted for getting a good grip on slippery prey.

50
YEARS

ESTIMATED LIFESPAN

STATS AND FACTS

Chomping down on turtles and other aquatic organisms requires heavy-duty jaws. *Deinosuchus's* powerful jaw muscles helped drive its massive teeth into blunt turtle shells. However, the fossils of some turtle shells show signs of healing, indicating they may have escaped from this deadly hunter.

WEBBED FEET



Deinosuchus's small, five-toed feet were partially webbed to stop them sinking into soft mud.

BITE FORCE



Deinosuchus had an estimated bite force of 11½ tons (10.4 tonnes), twice the bite power of a *T. rex*.

Feeding tactics

Turtles were probably a hungry *Deinosuchus's* favorite prey, but several dinosaur bones also show extensive bite marks that may have come from this reptile. Paleontologists think that *Deinosuchus* was probably capable of the "death roll"—a unique trait seen in modern-day crocodylians. After biting into the flesh of its prey, *Deinosuchus* would roll over, using its weight to tear chunks of meat off its victim's body.

STRONGEST
BITE:
CROCODYLIAN